CSE 6179 – Digital Forensics

Term Paper **Research/Survey on Related Topics** **Spring 2026**

Total marks: 20

Distribution of marks: See the rubric

Deadlines:

Assigned Tasks	Description	Deadline
Proposal submission	3 to 5 pages, Single spacing, Times new Roman, 12 points	Thu, 9 April 2026 (in ELMS)
Proposal presentation	8-10 min (max) per group (Approx. 10 slides)	Sat, 11 April 2026 – Last class before Mid Exam break during class time
Final Paper submission	15 pages maximum per group, Single spacing, Times new Roman, 12 points	Thu, 11 June 2026 (in ELMS, files in Google drive)
Final presentation	15 min (max) per group (Approx. 20-25 slides)	Sat, 13 June 2026 during class time

1. Problem Statement

The **objective of this assignment** is to survey state-of-the-art technologies in digital forensic investigation and write a research paper on a forensics-related topic.

2. Guidelines & Requirements

a. This is an academic paper. This means that peer reviewed (refereed) references need to be included. A rough guideline is to include **at least seven peer-reviewed references** and **at least fifteen total references**. Typical peer reviewed references include: ACM literature, IEEE literature, Internet RFCs. Web sites, newsgroups can be used as references, but are not peer-reviewed references.
b. **Create** a **shared Google drive (share with ME & all group members)** with your **Group ID** (i.e., **CSE_6179_Grp_2**) and put your referenced papers and documents there.
c. Papers MUST be prepared using the **Microsoft Word Template** (**ACM** or **IEEE** publication format).
d. **Deadlines** must be strictly maintained. **Deduction of marks** will be applied otherwise.

3. Marking Rubrics

Sl #	Criteria	Excellent (9-10)	Good (7-8)	Acceptable (5-6)	Poor (0-4)
1	Establishing the research context	Research problem is stated very clearly. Manageable numbers of objectives that is clear and aligned with the stated problem.	Research problem and objectives are stated but one or more are not stated in a clear and concise manner	Research problem is stated but there is lack of coherence between research purpose, problem/ opportunity and objectives	Research problem is too broad. Research objectives are not aligned with stated problem Research problem is vaguely stated while research objectives are not stated

Sl #	Criteria	Excellent (9-10)	Good (7-8)	Acceptable (5-6)	Poor (0-4)
2	Organization and structure	Shows a logical organization of ideas in constructing the overall argument. The pieces flow together well to produce a convincing line of reasoning.	Shows a logical organization of ideas, but may have minor problems.	The organization of ideas is not always clear or does not follow the research argument.	The organization of ideas is quite unclear or ineffective.
3	Quality of writing	There are no grammatical, spelling or punctuation errors.	There are minor grammatical, spelling or punctuation errors.	There are minor errors in punctuation, grammar and/or spelling which somewhat break the flow for the reader.	There are major errors in punctuation, grammar and/or spelling which interrupt the flow for the reader or difficult to read.
4	Quality and Use of References	Excellent connection to references is given to support claims. Attribution is clear and fairly represented. Confident about the source of information and ideas.	Clear connection to references is given to support claims. Attribution is, for the most part, clear and fairly represented.	Although attributions are occasionally given, many statements seem unsubstantiated. The reader is confused about the source of information and ideas.	References are seldom cited to support statements.
5	Copy/ Plagiarism (Similarity index)	Written in own language. No cut & paste. Very low similarity found with any other paper.	Mostly written in own language. Few cut & paste. Some similarity found with other papers.	Many cut & paste. High similarity found with other papers.	Mainly cut & paste. Very high similarity found with other papers.
6	Maintaining the guidelines/ Requirements	Length of the paper (# of the pages & formatting) & timing of the presentation fulfilled			Length of the paper (# of the pages & formatting), or timing of the presentation not fulfilled